



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Firearm Authorization and Identification System (FAIS) Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1. Introduction

Members within the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) who are issued service firearms to keep and care are usually a certain category of police officers. The absence of a proper system to quickly verify whether or not a member is authorized to be in possession of a service firearm presents a risk especially to officers performing duties in civilian attire.

1.1 Members Performing Duties in Civilian Attire

A policeman's uniform forms part of his identification. It tells the organization the person is employed with (eg. Jamaica Constabulary Force); the level within the organization the person is at, and sometimes gives an idea of the person's length of service from the insignia worn. This therefore, plays a very important role in augmenting the identification card. This additional form of identification is not extended to persons performing duties in civilian attire because of the need for them to be less overt and less visible than uniformed police personnel. In light of this, without an established system to quickly verify that a person is authorized to carry a firearm, armed criminals may get by police roadblocks and spot checks with illegal weapons by claiming to be police personnel if they are able to produce a police identification card.

1.2 Current Situation

When an armed person is stopped, declares himself as a police officer, contact is usually made with the division he is from, to verify if the person is assigned to that division and if he is authorized to be in possession of such firearm. This process may be a very lengthy and complicated one as the person in the division with whom the information lies might not be available. There are instances where it is verified that the person being checked is a police officer, however the division cannot confirm at the time that the person is authorized to carry the firearm. If the person is so authorized and is on an assignment, the assignment can sometimes get compromised by the unnecessary exposure and delays in trying to verify information in respect of the firearm. Being a police officer does not automatically authorize one to carry a service firearm, and certainly does not automatically authorize one to be in possession of a service firearm while off- duty. This vulnerability threatens the safety of the police officers on operations and presents opportunities for criminals to exploit.

2. Purpose

This document outlines the JCF's policy and standard operating procedures to formalize and update existing guidelines on firearm authorization and identification system.

3. Scope

This policy and standard operating procedures applies to all sworn members of the JCF and its auxiliary and covers the authorized identification system used by the JCF for keep and care firearms in possession of members

4. Abbreviations and Acronyms

FAIC	-	Firearm Authorization Identification Card
FAIS	-	Firearm Authorization Identification System
ICTD	-	Information and Communication Technology Division
PECC	-	Police Emergency Communication Centre

5. Responsibility

The following summarizes key responsibilities:

- 5.1 Divisional Commanders are responsible to maintain records of firearms that have been issued to police personnel to keep on and off duty
- 5.2 The Superintendent of Police in charge of the Information and Communication Technology Division (ICTD) shall be responsible to:
 - 5.2.1 manage and maintain the Firearms Authorization Identification System (FAIS) central database
 - 5.2.2 process and produce Firearms Authorization Identification Cards (FAIC) for members
- 5.3 All members are responsible for the safe custody and accountability of firearms issued to them to keep on and off duty; and shall present the FAIC when so required on the lawful request of any member on duty

6. Policy Statements

It is the policy of the JCF that:

- 6.1 A Firearms Authorization Identification System (FAIS) is established and shall consists of a central database to maintain records of all firearms assigned to members to keep on and off duty, and an identification card that is issued to such members who have been assigned such firearms;
- 6.2 All members armed with a service firearm to keep and care **MUST** carry the Firearm Authorization Identification Card (FAIC) on their person when in possession of the firearm. It is to be noted that:
 - i. the FAIC **MUST** be carried whether or not the officer is wearing uniform
 - ii. the FAIC **MUST** be carried whether or not the officer is on duty

- 6.3 Where an officer is performing duties in civilian attire and carries a firearm in an exposed manner, the FAIC **MUST** also be worn so that it is clearly visible.
- 6.4 Police officers who are off duty and are carrying keep and care service firearm **MUST** ensure that the firearm is properly concealed.

7. Standard Operating Procedures

7.1. Firearm Authorization and Identification System (FAIS)

The FAIS is a system that allows an officer on duty to quickly establish whether or not another officer is authorized to be in possession of a service firearm. It consists of a central database to maintain records of all firearms assigned to individuals to keep on and off duty, and an identification card that is issued to police persons who have been assigned firearms.

7.2. Central Database

7.2.1 All divisions/formations must keep records of firearms that have been issued to police personnel to keep on and off duty. The following information must be captured and fed into the central database:

7.2.1.1 Firearm

- i. Type
- ii. Make
- iii. Calibre
- iv. Serial Number – This may be used as the unique identifier of the firearm in the database
- v. Division Issued to
- vi. Last Inspection Date
- vii. Comments on Inspection

7.2.1.2 Police Assigned to

- i. Regulation Number
- ii. Rank
- iii. First Name
- iv. Last Name
- v. Division assigned to
- vi. Date of assignment of firearm

7.2.2 Police Emergency and Communication Centre (PECC) must have access to the central database to respond to queries on a twenty-four (24) hour basis. Search and retrieval of

information must be quick and easy so as not to negatively affect the activities of the parties involved.

7.3. Firearm Authorization and Identification Card (FAIC)

- 7.3.1. The FAIC must be issued to police officers whenever a service firearm is issued to keep and care.
- 7.3.2. The FAIC must be carried by the officer at all times and is to be produced forthwith when requested by a police in uniform, or a properly identified police officer.
- 7.3.3. The card must be produced along with the police identification card that will serve as a second photo ID.
- 7.3.4. The FAIC shall have sufficient information to verify the authority with which the person carries the firearm; however, if the officer is not satisfied, PECC may be contacted for further verification.
- 7.3.5. Each FAIC must be related to only one firearm and must bear the serial number of the firearm.
- 7.3.6. The following information must be included on the FAIC:

7.3.6.1. Firearm

- i. Serial number of Firearm
- ii. Type
- iii. Make
- iv. Model
- v. Calibre
- vi. Division Assigned

7.3.6.2. Police Assigned to

- i. Regulation Number
- ii. Rank
- iii. Name
- iv. Division Assigned to
- v. Date Firearm Assigned
- vi. Signature of Divisional Officer
- vii. Signature of Person Firearm is assigned to
- viii. Photograph of Holder

7.4. Assigning a Keep and Care Service Firearm & Generating the FAIC

Prior to issuing a keep and care service firearm the following must be done:

- 7.4.1. An application must be made by the member requesting (applicant) a keep and care firearm to the supervisor (Sub-Officer/Officer) in charge of the applicant. The *prescribed application form* “APPLICATION FOR KEEP AND CARE FIREARM” at Appendix A must be completed.
- 7.4.2. The supervisor will assess the need and forward the completed application form to the administration officer with a recommendation.
- 7.4.3. If recommended by the supervisor, the Administration Officer will cause an inspection to be done at the applicant’s home to verify that the infrastructure is adequately secure, and a holding safe is appropriately installed for the firearm.
- 7.4.4. The Administration Officer will forward the application form along with the inspection report and a recommendation to the Commanding Officer.
- 7.4.5. The Commanding Officer will approve or deny the application.
- 7.4.6. If the application is approved, the commanding officer will complete a Firearm Details Form as at Appendix B with the relevant information for the firearm that is to be assigned.
- 7.4.7. The completed application form and the firearms details form will be sent to the ICTD ID department for the preparation of the FAIC.
- 7.4.8. The ICTD ID department will update the FAIS database with the data on the prospective holder.
- 7.4.9. The ICTD ID department will contact the applicant and give him/her a date and time to visit the office for the taking of photograph and the preparation of the FAIC.
- 7.4.10. Once the applicant receives the FAIC, then he/she must present it to the Commanding Officer for the firearm to be issued.

8. Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

This Policy and SOP shall be read in conjunction with the:

- 8.1. JCF Human Rights and Use of Force and Firearms Policy

9. Records and Relevant Forms

- 9.1 FAIS Central Data Base
- 9.2 Application for Keep and Care Firearm Form (**Appendix A**)
- 9.3 Firearm Details Form (**Appendix B**)

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Applicant Must Complete Sections A-D

[illegible]

1

Male

9

Female

[illegible][illegible]

--	--	--	--

Mr. Mrs. Ms. Miss

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

DD/MM/YYYY

[illegible]

Address

Street

Town

[illegible]

City

Parish

[illegible]

How long have you been residing at this address?

[illegible]

Type of Premises/Building Structure

11

Rented

7

Owned

5

Other

[illegible]

SECTION B

Other occupier(s) of premises

Name 1)

[illegible]

Relationship

[illegible]

Relationship

[illegible]

Name 3)

[illegible]

Relationship

[illegible]

SECTION C

Rank

Date of Enlistment

[illegible]

Division or Formation Assigned to

[illegible]

Purpose for firearm

Type of firearm applying for

Type(s) of firearm qualified for

Safe Custody of firearm (Way of Storage)

SECTION D

Next of kin

First Name

[illegible]

Surname

[illegible]

Relationship

[illegible]

Address

Street

Town

[illegible]

City

Parish

[illegible]

Contact Number(s)

							or							
--	--	--	--	--	--	--	----	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

I declare that the information on this application is correct and complete. I acknowledge that I am liable for disciplinary charges if the information contained in this application form is a misrepresentation of the facts or not known to me to be true.

Applicant signature _____

Date ____/____/____

SECTION E

Recommended by Supervisor

11

Yes

11

No

Supervisor signature _____

Date ____/____/____

SECTION F**FOR OFFICIAL USE**

Recommended by Administration Officer

☐

Yes

☐

No

Admin Officer's Comment

Admin Officer Signature _____

Date ____/____/____

Approved by Commanding Officer

☐

Yes

☐

No

Commanding Officer's Comment

Authorizing Signature

Date

/

/

APPENDIX: B
JCF/FW/PL/Adm/0006/2022/F02

FIREARM DETAILS FORM

Applicant's Information

Surname

[illegible]

Sex: Male

Female

1

First Name

[illegible]

Middle

[illegible]

Rank

[illegible]

Firearm Details

Type

[illegible]

Make

[illegible]

Model

[illegible]

Calibre

[illegible]

Serial Number

[illegible]

Division

[illegible]

Commanding Officer Signature_____

Date ____/____/____

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